



free will
and
determinism

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the reality of free will.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

A compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist believer in free will rejects premise (2).

Let's start with the first premise, which says that free will is incompatible with determinism. The main argument for this premise is the **consequence argument**.

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one for the first premise, and one for the second premise.

One way to present this argument starts with two very plausible premises.

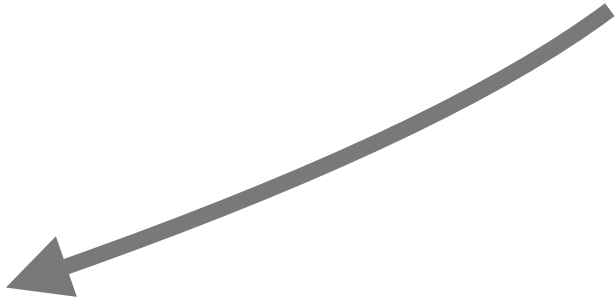
No one has any choice about the
state of the world in the
distant past.

No one has any choice
about what the laws of
nature are.

No one has any choice about the combination of the state of the world in the distant past + the laws of nature.



If determinism is true, no one
has any choice about any future
action.

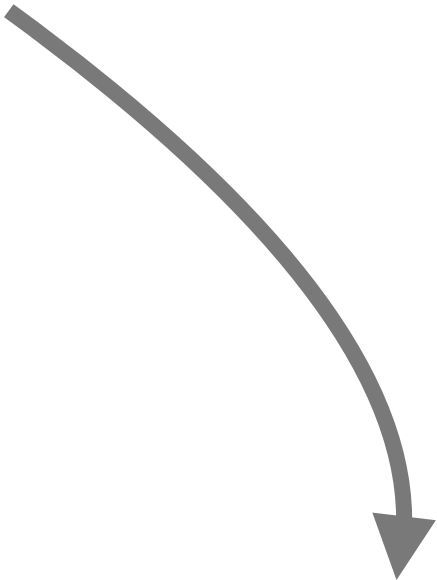


If determinism is true,
then the state of the
world in the distant past
+ the laws of nature
necessitate every future
action.



If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X , we have no choice about X .





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A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

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C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

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